Home Emergency Kit Checklist

From the free guide at https://jaechung-glitch.github.io/bugout/guides/emergency-kit-list/, which lists its sources (FEMA's Ready.gov Build a Kit list and CDC guidance). Updated November 9, 2026.

General safety information, not medical advice or a substitute for training. In an emergency, call 911.

The basic emergency kit

This is the Basic Disaster Supplies Kit from FEMA's Ready.gov, item for item.

- [ ] Water: 1 gallon per person per day, for several days
  For drinking and sanitation. Use our water calculator for your household's total.
- [ ] Food: at least several days of non-perishable food
  Food that needs no fridge and little or no cooking.
- [ ] A battery-powered or hand-crank radio, and a NOAA Weather Radio with tone alert
  For warnings and news when phones and power are down.
- [ ] A flashlight
- [ ] A first-aid kit
- [ ] Extra batteries
- [ ] A whistle
  To signal for help.
- [ ] Dust masks
  To help filter contaminated air.
- [ ] Plastic sheeting, scissors and duct tape
  To shelter in place.
- [ ] Moist towelettes, garbage bags and plastic ties
  For personal sanitation.
- [ ] A wrench or pliers
  To turn off utilities.
- [ ] A manual can opener
- [ ] Local maps
  On paper: your phone may be dead or out of signal.
- [ ] A cell phone with chargers and a backup battery

What to add for your household

FEMA's list of additional supplies covers the things that differ from one family to the next.

HEALTH AND HYGIENE

- [ ] Prescription medicines
- [ ] Non-prescription medicines: pain relievers, anti-diarrhea medicine, antacids or laxatives
- [ ] Prescription glasses and contact lens solution
- [ ] Soap, hand sanitizer and disinfecting wipes
- [ ] Feminine supplies and personal hygiene items

BABIES, CHILDREN AND PETS

- [ ] Infant formula, bottles, diapers, wipes and diaper rash cream
- [ ] Books, games, puzzles or other activities for children
- [ ] Pet food and extra water for your pet

DOCUMENTS AND MONEY

- [ ] Copies of insurance policies, identification and bank account records
  Saved electronically, or in a waterproof container you can carry.
- [ ] Cash or traveler's checks
  Card readers and ATMs need power and a network.
- [ ] Paper and pencil

WARMTH, COOKING AND SAFETY

- [ ] A sleeping bag or warm blanket for each person
- [ ] A complete change of clothing suited to your climate, and sturdy shoes
- [ ] A fire extinguisher
- [ ] Matches in a waterproof container
- [ ] Mess kits, paper cups, plates, paper towels and plastic utensils

Keep it ready

- [ ] Keep canned food in a cool, dry place
- [ ] Store boxed food in tightly closed plastic or metal containers
- [ ] Replace expired items as needed
- [ ] Replace water you bottled yourself every 6 months
- [ ] Rethink your needs every year and update the kit as your family changes